

Cheating does not pay

A Hungry **stag** saw a ram **guarding** a basket of wheat. He wanted to eat some wheat and so he went to the ram and said, "I see you have wheat inside that basket. I'm **terribly** hungry. Will you give it to me?"

"Sorry, I cannot," replied the ram. "The wheat belongs to my master."

"Look, friend," said the stag. "I'm only asking you to **lend** it to me. I'll return it to you as soon as I can." The ram felt sorry for the stag.

"All right," he said to the stag. "But how do I know you will return it to me?"

"You can trust me!" said the stag.

"I shall give you the wheat provided you bring someone to stand **surety** for you," said the ram finally.

The stag agreed. He hadn't gone far before he met a wolf.

"I'm hungry and the ram has some wheat. He will lend me the wheat only if I find someone to **stand as surety**, until I return it to him," said the stag. "Will you, friend wolf?"



"Me, as surety? No way!" said the wolf. "But I have an idea. I'll come with you and as soon as the ram gives you the wheat, you and I will run away with it!"

The hungry stag agreed.

"But what will you give me in return for helping you?" asked the wolf.

"I'll give you half the wheat," said the stag.

And, together they went to the ram.

"Here's my surety!" said the stag.

"Now will you give me the wheat?"

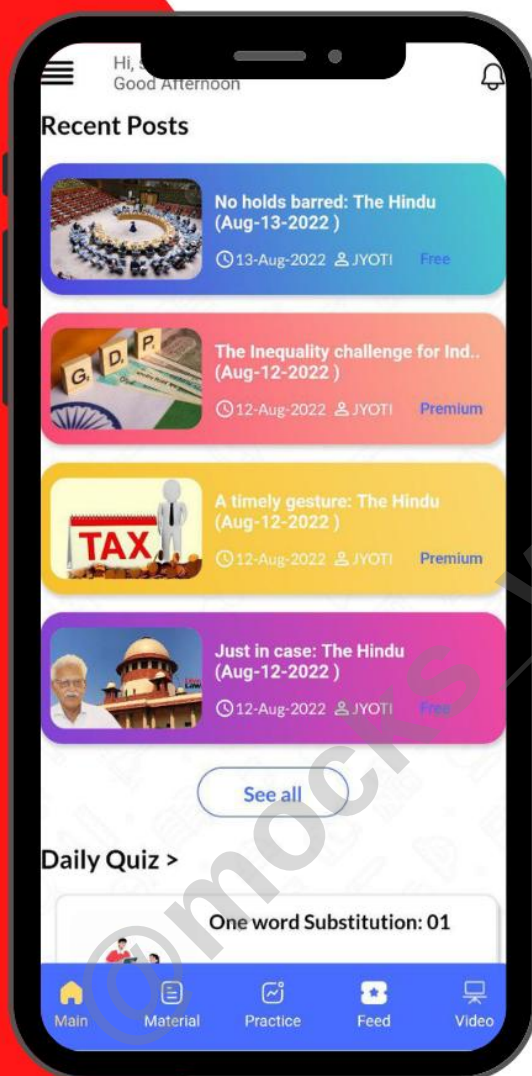
The ram took one look at the wolf and knew at once that the two animals were up to some **trick**.

"Sorry, I've changed my mind. I don't **intend** to give the wheat to you or to any other **ungrateful scoundrel** for that matter!" said the ram angrily, and before they could move, he charged at the wolf.

The stag and the wolf were so **startled** by the unexpected **turn of events** that they **fled** the place as fast as they could.

Vocabulary

1. **Stag** (noun) – deer, buck, antlered animal, hart, male deer – हिरन (नर)
2. **Guard** (verb) – protect, watch over, secure, shield, defend – रक्षा करना / निगरानी रखना
3. **Terribly** (adverb) – extremely, very, awfully, intensely, desperately – बहुत ज्यादा / बेहद
4. **Lend** (verb) – loan, give temporarily, grant, advance, provide – उधार देना
5. **Surety** (noun) – guarantor, security, bond, assurance, warranty – जमानत / ज़िम्मेदार व्यक्ति
6. **Stand** (verb) – act as, represent, support, substitute, serve – स्थायी होना / बनना / प्रतिनिधित्व करना
7. **Surety** (noun) – guarantee, assurance, pledge, bail, bond जमानतदार
8. **Trick** (noun) – deception, ruse, ploy, hoax, scheme – चाल / धोखा
9. **Intend** (verb) – plan, aim, mean, propose, purpose – इरादा रखना / चाहना
10. **Ungrateful** (adjective) – thankless, unappreciative, inconsiderate, selfish, disloyal – अकृतज्ञ / एहसान फरामोश
11. **Scoundrel** (noun) – rogue, villain, knave, miscreant, crook – दुष्ट / नीच व्यक्ति
12. **Startled** (adjective) – shocked, surprised, alarmed, stunned, frightened – चकित / चौंका हुआ
13. **Turn of events** (phrase) – a new development or change in a situation घटनाक्रम में बदलाव
14. **Flee** (verb) – run away, escape, bolt, take flight, abscond – भाग जाना



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